

COFFEE BARS



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80,000

tonne is the annual consumption of coffee in the country. Per capita consumption in India is only 80 gm.

Rs 48,000

is what the best cafes in Bangalore bring in daily. A typical cafe in Bangalore will earn an average Rs 3,500 daily.

NEW BREW:
Catching up over coffee in Gurgaon

with the smell of leaves brewing instead of beans mixing. Any caffeine addiction earlier owed much to the chain of Coffee Houses, a South-India-based establishment. The first cooperative was formed in Bangalore and the first restaurant came up in Delhi in 1957. The chain celebrates its golden jubilee this year and a series of failed revamps later, the coffee house revolution is on its last leg, fast being replaced by a spiffier version.

Enter the coffee bar, through Barista, a chain that now operates over 100 outlets nationwide. With air-conditioned comfort and modern decor, it modelled itself after the US coffee chain, Starbucks. Then came a flood of coffee brands, such as Café Coffee Day, Mocha, Costa Coffee and Coffee World, each vying to lure Indian consumers with caramel, espresso, Americano, latte, Italiano and other flavours from around the world. Café Coffee Day essentially targeted the teenager while Qwicky spread its wings in the South.

And with a fair bit of merchandising thrown in, complete with candles, extra-large mugs, Jamaican coffee beans and pink teddy bears when Valentine's Day comes around, coffee comes packaged for today's consumer. The coffee retail industry is expected to comprise over 5,000 outlets by the turn of the decade. With a burgeoning upper-middle class market of 20 crore people, most coffee shops are targeting the 16-35 age group, a section with huge potential spends, courtesy the new economy and an emerging society.

Close to midnight, when everyone around is in deep slumber, the local coffee outlet sees senior citizens walk in for a quiet after-dinner drink. Couples catch up after a hard day at work, a group of young people pick up the complimentary guitar on the wall to strum impromptu notes, and sports freaks catch up on the latest champions league football match, all with a steaming, hot cup of coffee, the new world's new drink. ■

